

Weight — Tool Build (instrument + atmosphere)

Direction: Speed Bump. Friction that reads as deliberate, never punitive. Everyday Tools — Fordham Wong

Live link	fwong29.github.io/reusable-studio-engine/everyday-tools/
Repository	github.com/fwong29/reusable-studio-engine — project in <code>everyday-tools/</code>
Commit history	/commits/main — build spans 2026-09-18 and 2026-09-22, each commit one named change
Break log	in the README — five reproduced breaks keyed to commit hashes (shared with the mechanics phase)
Video reflection	submitted as a second file on this assignment (answers below)

REFINED INTERFACE

Atmosphere — refined interface (Speed Bump)



TYPOGRAPHY

Space Mono for values — a metered, mechanical face for a machine that counts. **Inter** for human-voice labels. Hierarchy: tally numeral (44) → display (28) → keys (18) → nameplate (12, wide tracking).

7 7 + 3 x - WEIGHT

SPATIAL RHYTHM

One consistent **12px gutter** everywhere. The tally sits alone in a tall panel with real air around the numeral, so the number being built is the calm center — not crowded by keys.

COLOR

Warm bone ground, a single **terracotta accent that means one thing: effort**. It appears only on the tally marks and operator keys. = is near-black (a full stop); controls stay quiet cream.



The four atmosphere dimensions annotated: typography, spatial rhythm, color.

MOTION & TIMING

W Atmosphere — motion & timing

Motion is reserved for meaning. Nothing animates idle. The slowest beat is the moment a quantity becomes real.

ON EACH TAP

220_{ms}



Tap

The new mark scales in; the numeral ticks up. Small, so seven of them still read as effort, not noise.



OPERATOR COMMITS THE NUMBER

500_{ms}



Land

Panel and display settle together. The slowest beat by design — this is when the quantity becomes real.



ON =

400_{ms}



Result

The answer arrives with a brief fade-and-scale — present, not triumphant. No celebration.



ON C

300_{ms}



Clear

A quiet fade to zero. Nothing was stored; nothing to erase but the screen.

All ease-out (cubic-bezier .2,.8,.2,1), declared as `--t-tap / --t-land / --t-result / --t-clear` in one place. **All disabled under prefers-reduced-motion** — the friction is in the count, never in withheld motion.

Four timed beats. The slowest (500ms) is the moment a number commits — when a quantity becomes real.

WHAT CHANGED FROM MECHANICS

W Atmosphere — what changed from mechanics



DELTA

Tally marks: faint 5px grey dots → bold 14×6 terracotta pills. The seam now reads instantly as a count.

Accent: muted brick (#a8462c) → warmer terracotta (#d9572a), used only for effort.

Numerals: 40px → 44px bold; the number being built is now the largest thing on screen.

Motion: none (50ms key press) → four timed beats, tap 220 / land 500 / result 400 / clear 300.

Space: 10px gutters → consistent 12px; taller tally panel, more air around the numeral.

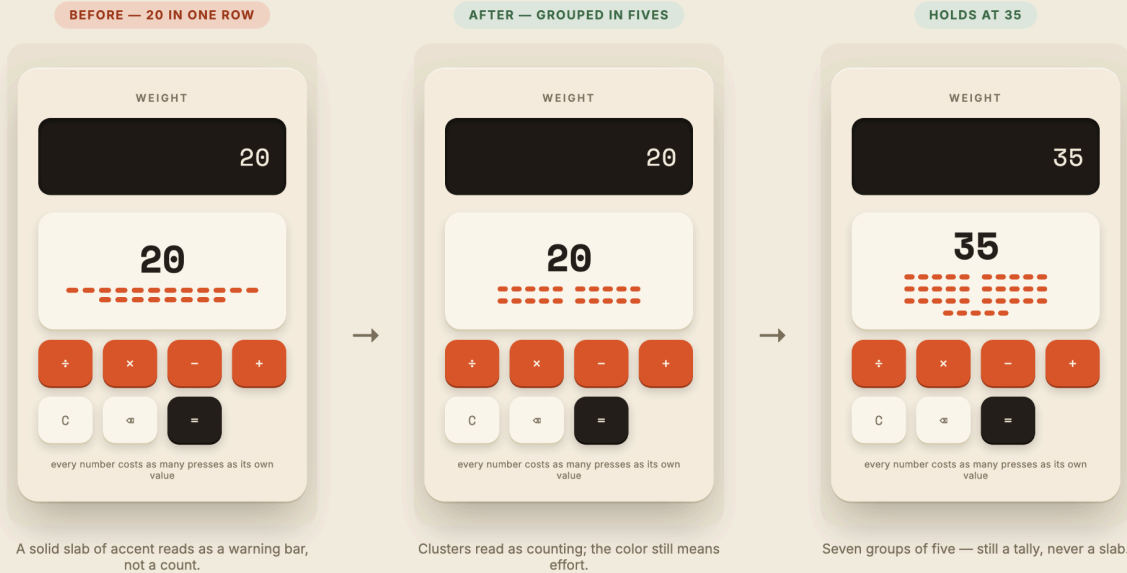
Error: plain text → accent-colored, distinct from a blank state. Reduced-motion respected.

Same mechanic, refined temperature — the tally seam goes from faint grey dots to bold terracotta pills.

TESTING THE ACCENT RULE AT SCALE

W Atmosphere — does the accent rule hold at scale?

Tested the count above twenty. It did not — so the design changed to keep the rule true.



THE FINDING

The rule — **accent means one thing, effort** — broke at density: above ~20 an unbroken terracotta row tipped from *count* into *pressure*. Grouping the marks in fives (a physical tally) fixes it without touching the color: the eye parses rhythmic clusters, the count stays legible at a glance, and the accent keeps its single meaning at any length.

Watching the tally above twenty showed the "accent = effort" rule breaking; grouping the marks in fives keeps the color's single meaning at any length.

VIDEO REFLECTION

Submitted as a short video (in my own voice) alongside this PDF. It answers:

What changed from mechanics to atmosphere? The mechanic stayed the same; what changed was how it feels — grey dots became bold terracotta pills grouped in fives, motion was timed so the slowest beat is when a number commits, and the accent was reserved to mean one thing: effort.

How did those changes shift the emotional experience? It moved from a neutral gadget toward something patient — the friction reads as deliberate rather than punishing. It never celebrates or shames; it just asks you to feel the number.